

1.百折不挠 **bǎi zhé bù náo**: Literally this means, “One hundred breaks/losses, no scratch/yield.” So the meaning here is to keep on fighting in spite of all setbacks or to be indomitable. This is a great one to keep in mind when studying Mandarin.

2.水滴石穿 **shuǐ dī shí chuān**: Literally this means, “Water drops, stone is bored through.” In other words dripping water can penetrate through rocks. The idea here is closely related to the English saying, “little strokes fell great oaks.” This idiom encourages you to be persistent and keep your goals in mind.

3.大惑不解 **dà huò bù jiě**: Literally this means, “large confusion, no understanding.” The idiom means to be at a complete loss or to be unable to make head or tail of something. Sometimes I feel this way when studying new characters and so it is an appropriate 成语 chéng yǔ to use here.

4.烟消云散 **yān xiāo yún sàn**: Literally this means, “Smoke vanishes, clouds disperse.” In other words, to vanish like smoke as disperse like clouds. The meaning here is to completely vanish or disappear. Perhaps in English a close comparison could be when we say someone went AWOL.

5.捡了芝麻, 丢了西瓜 **jiǎn le zhī ma , diū le xī guā**: Literally this means, “To pick out the seeds and neglect the watermelon.” In other words, to dwell on trifle issues and thus lose sight of the bigger picture. This idiom is interesting because it uses the imagery of food, (who doesn’ t love watermelon?), to explain a larger issue. This is definitely one of my favorites。

6.将信将疑 **jiāng xìn jiāng yí**: This literally means, “to use belief and to use doubt.” In other words half believing and half doubting. You can use this idiom to describe a situation in which you feel skeptical or not completely convinced.

7.拒之门外 **jù zhī mén wài**: This literally means, “to refuse what is outside the door.” The meaning behind this idiom is to lock the door and refuse to see someone, or in other words, completely refuse or disregard someone or something.

8.如获至宝 **rú huò zhì bǎo**: This idioms meaning is, “ as if one had found a priceless treasure. ” For me, this describes my sentiments towards learning Mandarin, as it is indeed as if I have stumbled upon a priceless treasure.

9.在家靠父母, 出门靠朋友 **zài jiā kào fù mǔ , chū mén kào péng you**: This one is interesting because it talks about the significance of relationships, literally, “At home you rely on your parents, but when you go out into the world you rely on friends.” This tells you the significance of friends in your life and how important it is to have someone to rely on, as well as to be someone reliable for your fellow friend.

10.便宜一分是一份 **pián yi yì fēn shì yí fèn**: This is a financial saying and if you use it when bargaining it probably will get you that discount. It literally means that with regards to money, even one cent is a part of the whole. In other words even one cent can make a difference.